

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Caste System: Structure and Contemporary Dynamics - Learner-v2 Refreshed

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

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BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Varna as ideal type?

A. Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit. B. Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates. C. Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory. D. Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework.

Answer: A. Explanation: Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under Varna as ideal type?

A. Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates. B. Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit. C. Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder. D. Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory.

Answer: B. Explanation: Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Varna as ideal type?

A. Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder. B. Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared. C. Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit. D. Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory.

Answer: C. Explanation: Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Varna as ideal type?

A. Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder. B. Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared. C. M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows. D. Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit.

Answer: D. Explanation: Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies Jati as the real unit?

A. Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework. B. Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates. C. Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory. D. Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder.

Answer: A. Explanation: Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q6. Which chronology card should be filed under Jati as the real unit?

A. Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory. B. Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework. C. Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared. D. Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder.

Answer: B. Explanation: Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Jati as the real unit?

A. Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared. B. M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows. C. Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework. D. Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder.

Answer: C. Explanation: Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Jati as the real unit?

A. Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy. B. Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared. C. M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows. D. Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework.

Answer: D. Explanation: Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Four defining features?

A. Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates. B. Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder. C. Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared. D. Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory.

Answer: A. Explanation: Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q10. Which chronology card should be filed under Four defining features?

A. M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows. B. Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates. C. Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared. D. Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder.

Answer: B. Explanation: Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q11. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Four defining features?

A. Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy. B. Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared. C. Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates. D. M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows.

Answer: C. Explanation: Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q12. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Four defining features?

A. Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy. B. M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows. C. Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs. D. Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates.

Answer: D. Explanation: Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Endogamy with gotra exogamy?

A. Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory. B. Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared. C. M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows. D. Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder.

Answer: A. Explanation: Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q14. Which chronology card should be filed under Endogamy with gotra exogamy?

A. M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows. B. Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory. C. Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared. D. Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy.

Answer: B. Explanation: Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q15. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Endogamy with gotra exogamy?

A. Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs. B. Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy. C. Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory. D. M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows.

Answer: C. Explanation: Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q16. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Endogamy with gotra exogamy?

A. Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs. B. A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank. C. Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy. D. Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory.

Answer: D. Explanation: Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Locally variable hierarchy?

A. Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder. B. Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy. C. Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared. D. M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows.

Answer: A. Explanation: Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q18. Which chronology card should be filed under Locally variable hierarchy?

A. Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs. B. Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder. C. Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy. D. M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows.

Answer: B. Explanation: Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q19. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Locally variable hierarchy?

A. Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs. B. A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank. C. Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder. D. Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy.

Answer: C. Explanation: Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q20. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Locally variable hierarchy?

A. Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs. B. A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank. C. Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment. D. Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder.

Answer: D. Explanation: Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Occupational decoupling?

A. Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared. B. M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows. C. Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy. D. Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs.

Answer: A. Explanation: Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q22. Which chronology card should be filed under Occupational decoupling?

A. Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy. B. Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared. C. A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank. D. Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs.

Answer: B. Explanation: Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q23. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Occupational decoupling?

A. A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank. B. Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment. C. Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared. D. Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs.

Answer: C. Explanation: Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q24. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Occupational decoupling?

A. Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual. B. A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank. C. Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment. D. Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared.

Answer: D. Explanation: Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Sanskritisation?

A. M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows. B. A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank. C. Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs. D. Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy.

Answer: A. Explanation: M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q26. Which chronology card should be filed under Sanskritisation?

A. Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment. B. M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows. C. Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs. D. A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank.

Answer: B. Explanation: M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q27. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Sanskritisation?

A. Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual. B. Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment. C. M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows. D. A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank.

Answer: C. Explanation: M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q28. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Sanskritisation?

A. Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment. B. An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis. C. Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual. D. M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows.

Answer: D. Explanation: M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Westernisation?

A. Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy. B. Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs. C. A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank. D. Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment.

Answer: A. Explanation: Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q30. Which chronology card should be filed under Westernisation?

A. Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual. B. Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy. C. A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank. D. Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment.

Answer: B. Explanation: Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q31. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Westernisation?

A. Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual. B. An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis. C. Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy. D. Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment.

Answer: C. Explanation: Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q32. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Westernisation?

A. Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations. B. Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual. C. An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis. D. Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy.

Answer: D. Explanation: Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Rampura fieldwork?

A. Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs. B. Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment. C. Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual. D. A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank.

Answer: A. Explanation: Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q34. Which chronology card should be filed under Rampura fieldwork?

A. Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment. B. Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs. C. Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual. D. An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis.

Answer: B. Explanation: Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q35. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Rampura fieldwork?

A. Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations. B. Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual. C. Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs. D. An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis.

Answer: C. Explanation: Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q36. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Rampura fieldwork?

A. An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis. B. A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit. C. Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations. D. Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs.

Answer: D. Explanation: Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Dominant caste?

A. A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank. B. Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual. C. An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis. D. Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment.

Answer: A. Explanation: A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q38. Which chronology card should be filed under Dominant caste?

A. An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis. B. A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank. C. Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual. D. Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations.

Answer: B. Explanation: A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q39. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Dominant caste?

A. An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis. B. A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit. C. A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank. D. Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations.

Answer: C. Explanation: A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q40. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Dominant caste?

A. A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit. B. Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations. C. Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance. D. A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank.

Answer: D. Explanation: A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Caste-class overlap and cross-cutting?

A. Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment. B. An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis. C. Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations. D. Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual.

Answer: A. Explanation: Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q42. Which chronology card should be filed under Caste-class overlap and cross-cutting?

A. A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit. B. Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment. C. An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis. D. Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations.

Answer: B. Explanation: Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q43. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Caste-class overlap and cross-cutting?

A. A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit. B. Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance. C. Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment. D. Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations.

Answer: C. Explanation: Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q44. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Caste-class overlap and cross-cutting?

A. Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings. B. Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance. C. A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit. D. Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment.

Answer: D. Explanation: Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Caste associations?

A. Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual. B. A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit. C. An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis. D. Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations.

Answer: A. Explanation: Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q46. Which chronology card should be filed under Caste associations?

A. Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance. B. Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual. C. Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations. D. A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit.

Answer: B. Explanation: Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q47. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Caste associations?

A. Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance. B. A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit. C. Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual. D. Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings.

Answer: C. Explanation: Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q48. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Caste associations?

A. The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead. B. Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance. C. Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings. D. Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual.

Answer: D. Explanation: Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Caste is not ethnicity?

A. An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis. B. A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit. C. Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance. D. Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations.

Answer: A. Explanation: An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q50. Which chronology card should be filed under Caste is not ethnicity?

A. Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance. B. An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis. C. A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit. D. Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings.

Answer: B. Explanation: An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q51. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Caste is not ethnicity?

A. Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings. B. The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead. C. An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis. D. Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance.

Answer: C. Explanation: An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q52. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Caste is not ethnicity?

A. Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings. B. The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead. C. The Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration in Census 2027 and Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes its reference dates; the operation is prospective, no caste count exists to quote, and post-Independence Censuses not enumerating all castes does not make this India's first historical caste count. D. An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis.

Answer: D. Explanation: An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Fluid rank and rigid boundary?

A. Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations. B. Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance. C. Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings. D. A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit.

Answer: A. Explanation: Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q54. Which chronology card should be filed under Fluid rank and rigid boundary?

A. Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance. B. Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations. C. Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings. D. The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued

instead.

Answer: B. Explanation: Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q55. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Fluid rank and rigid boundary?

A. The Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration in Census 2027 and Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes its reference dates; the operation is prospective, no caste count exists to quote, and post-Independence Censuses not enumerating all castes does not make this India's first historical caste count. B. Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings. C. Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations. D. The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead.

Answer: C. Explanation: Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q56. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Fluid rank and rigid boundary?

A. The Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration in Census 2027 and Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes its reference dates; the operation is prospective, no caste count exists to quote, and post-Independence Censuses not enumerating all castes does not make this India's first historical caste count. B. The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead. C. Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: 2024 on intercaste versus interreligious marriage worth 10 marks, 2018 on caste assuming new identities and associational forms worth 10, 2020 on caste's relevance in a multi-cultural society worth 10, 2022 on the salience of sect worth 15 and 2023 on caste identity being both fluid and static worth 15. D. Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations.

Answer: D. Explanation: Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Sect is not caste?

A. A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit. B. The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead. C. Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance. D. Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings.

Answer: A. Explanation: A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q58. Which chronology card should be filed under Sect is not caste?

A. The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead. B. A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit. C. Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings. D. The Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration in Census 2027 and Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes its reference dates; the operation is prospective, no caste count exists to quote, and post-Independence Censuses not enumerating all castes does not make this India's first historical caste count.

Answer: B. Explanation: A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q59. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Sect is not caste?

A. Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: 2024 on intercaste versus interreligious marriage worth 10 marks, 2018 on caste assuming new identities and associational forms worth 10, 2020 on caste's relevance in a multi-cultural society worth 10, 2022 on the salience of sect worth 15 and 2023 on caste identity being both fluid and static worth 15. B. The Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration in Census 2027 and Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes its reference dates; the operation is prospective, no caste count exists to quote, and post-Independence Censuses not enumerating all castes does not make this India's first historical caste count. C. A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit. D. The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead.

Answer: C. Explanation: A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q60. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Sect is not caste?

A. Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: 2024 on intercaste versus interreligious marriage worth 10 marks, 2018 on caste assuming new identities and associational forms worth 10, 2020 on caste's relevance in a multi-cultural society worth 10, 2022 on the salience of sect worth 15 and 2023 on caste identity being both fluid and static worth 15. B. The Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration in Census 2027 and Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes its reference dates; the operation is prospective, no caste count exists to quote, and post-Independence Censuses not enumerating all castes does not make this India's first historical caste count. C. Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit. D. A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit.

Answer: D. Explanation: A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Arena-specific salience?

A. Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance. B. The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead. C. The Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration in Census 2027 and Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes its reference dates; the operation is prospective, no caste count exists to quote, and post-Independence Censuses not enumerating all castes does not make this India's first historical caste count. D. Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings.

Answer: A. Explanation: Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q62. Which chronology card should be filed under Arena-specific salience?

A. Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: 2024 on intercaste versus interreligious marriage worth 10 marks, 2018 on caste assuming new identities and associational forms worth 10, 2020 on caste's relevance in a multi-cultural society worth 10, 2022 on the salience of sect worth 15 and 2023 on caste identity being both fluid and static worth 15. B. Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance. C. The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead. D. The Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration in Census 2027 and Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes its reference dates; the operation is prospective, no caste count exists to quote, and post-Independence Censuses not enumerating all castes does not make this India's first historical caste count.

Answer: B. Explanation: Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q63. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Arena-specific salience?

A. The Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration in Census 2027 and Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes its reference dates; the operation is prospective, no caste count exists to quote, and post-Independence Censuses not enumerating all castes does not make this India's first historical caste count. B. Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit. C. Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance. D. Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: 2024 on intercaste versus interreligious marriage worth 10 marks, 2018 on caste assuming new identities and associational forms worth 10, 2020 on caste's relevance in a multi-cultural society worth 10, 2022 on the salience of sect worth 15 and 2023 on caste identity being both fluid and static worth 15.

Answer: C. Explanation: Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q64. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Arena-specific salience?

A. Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework. B. Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit. C. Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: 2024 on intercaste versus interreligious marriage worth 10 marks, 2018 on caste assuming new identities and associational forms worth 10, 2020 on caste's relevance in a multi-cultural society worth 10, 2022 on the salience of sect worth 15 and 2023 on caste identity being both fluid and static worth 15. D. Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance.

Answer: D. Explanation: Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Status-parity marriage mechanism?

A. Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings. B. The Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration in Census 2027 and Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes its reference dates; the operation is prospective, no caste count exists to quote, and post-Independence Censuses not enumerating all castes does not make this India's first historical caste count. C. The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead. D. Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: 2024 on intercaste versus interreligious marriage worth 10 marks, 2018 on caste assuming new identities and associational forms worth 10, 2020 on caste's relevance in a multi-cultural society worth 10, 2022 on the salience of sect worth 15 and 2023 on caste identity being both fluid and static worth 15.

Answer: A. Explanation: Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q66. Which chronology card should be filed under Status-parity marriage mechanism?

A. The Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration in Census 2027 and Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes its reference dates; the operation is prospective, no caste count exists to quote, and post-Independence Censuses not enumerating all castes does not make this India's first historical caste count. B. Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings. C. Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit. D. Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: 2024 on intercaste versus interreligious marriage worth 10 marks, 2018 on caste assuming new identities and associational forms worth 10, 2020 on caste's relevance in a multi-cultural society worth 10, 2022 on the salience of sect worth 15 and 2023 on caste identity being both fluid and static worth 15.

Answer: B. Explanation: Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q67. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Status-parity marriage mechanism?

A. Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit. B. Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework. C. Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings. D. Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: 2024 on intercaste versus interreligious marriage worth 10 marks, 2018 on caste assuming new identities and associational forms worth 10, 2020 on caste's relevance in a multi-cultural society worth 10, 2022 on the salience of sect worth 15 and 2023 on caste identity being both fluid and static worth 15.

Answer: C. Explanation: Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q68. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Status-parity marriage mechanism?

A. Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit. B. Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates. C. Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework. D. Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings.

Answer: D. Explanation: Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Special Marriage Act civil route?

A. The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead. B. Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: 2024 on intercaste versus interreligious marriage worth 10 marks, 2018 on caste assuming new identities and associational forms worth 10, 2020 on caste's relevance in a multi-cultural society worth 10, 2022 on the salience of sect worth 15 and 2023 on caste identity being both fluid and static worth 15. C. The Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration in Census 2027 and Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes its reference dates; the operation is prospective, no caste count exists to quote, and post-Independence Censuses not enumerating all castes does not make this India's first historical caste count. D. Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under Special Marriage Act civil route?

A. Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: 2024 on intercaste versus interreligious marriage worth 10 marks, 2018 on caste assuming new identities and associational forms worth 10, 2020 on caste's relevance in a multi-cultural society worth 10, 2022 on the salience of sect worth 15 and 2023 on caste identity being both fluid and static worth 15. B. The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead. C. Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit. D. Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Special Marriage Act civil route?

A. Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit. B. Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework. C. The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead. D. Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Special Marriage Act civil route?

A. Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory. B. Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates. C. Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework. D. The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Caste-census measurement status?

A. The Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration in Census 2027 and Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes its reference dates; the operation is prospective, no caste count exists to quote, and post-Independence Censuses not enumerating all castes does not make this India's first historical caste count. B. Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework. C. Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: 2024 on intercaste versus interreligious marriage worth 10 marks, 2018 on caste assuming new identities and associational forms worth 10, 2020 on caste's relevance in a multi-cultural society worth 10, 2022 on the salience of sect worth 15 and 2023 on caste identity being both fluid and static worth 15. D. Varna is

the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration in Census 2027 and Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes its reference dates; the operation is prospective, no caste count exists to quote, and post-Independence Censuses not enumerating all castes does not make this India's first historical caste count. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q74. Which chronology card should be filed under Caste-census measurement status?

A. Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit. B. The Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration in Census 2027 and Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes its reference dates; the operation is prospective, no caste count exists to quote, and post-Independence Censuses not enumerating all castes does not make this India's first historical caste count. C. Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates. D. Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration in Census 2027 and Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes its reference dates; the operation is prospective, no caste count exists to quote, and post-Independence Censuses not enumerating all castes does not make this India's first historical caste count. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q75. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Caste-census measurement status?

A. Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates. B. Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory. C. The Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration in Census 2027 and Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes its reference dates; the operation is prospective, no caste count exists to quote, and post-Independence Censuses not enumerating all castes does not make this India's first historical caste count. D. Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration in Census 2027 and Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes its reference dates; the operation is prospective, no caste count exists to quote, and post-Independence Censuses not enumerating all castes does not make this India's first historical caste count. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q76. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Caste-census measurement status?

A. Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates. B. Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder. C. Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory. D. The Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration in Census 2027 and Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes its reference dates; the operation is prospective, no caste count exists to quote, and post-Independence Censuses not enumerating all castes does not make this India's first historical caste count.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration in Census 2027 and Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes its reference dates; the operation is prospective, no caste count exists to quote, and post-Independence Censuses not enumerating all castes does not make

this India's first historical caste count. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Verified direct Mains demands?

A. Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: 2024 on intercaste versus interreligious marriage worth 10 marks, 2018 on caste assuming new identities and associational forms worth 10, 2020 on caste's relevance in a multi-cultural society worth 10, 2022 on the salience of sect worth 15 and 2023 on caste identity being both fluid and static worth 15. B. Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates. C. Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit. D. Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework.

Answer: A. Explanation: Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: 2024 on intercaste versus interreligious marriage worth 10 marks, 2018 on caste assuming new identities and associational forms worth 10, 2020 on caste's relevance in a multi-cultural society worth 10, 2022 on the salience of sect worth 15 and 2023 on caste identity being both fluid and static worth 15. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Verified direct Mains demands?

A. Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates. B. Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: 2024 on intercaste versus interreligious marriage worth 10 marks, 2018 on caste assuming new identities and associational forms worth 10, 2020 on caste's relevance in a multi-cultural society worth 10, 2022 on the salience of sect worth 15 and 2023 on caste identity being both fluid and static worth 15. C. Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework. D. Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory.

Answer: B. Explanation: Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: 2024 on intercaste versus interreligious marriage worth 10 marks, 2018 on caste assuming new identities and associational forms worth 10, 2020 on caste's relevance in a multi-cultural society worth 10, 2022 on the salience of sect worth 15 and 2023 on caste identity being both fluid and static worth 15. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Verified direct Mains demands?

A. Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates. B. Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory. C. Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: 2024 on intercaste versus interreligious marriage worth 10 marks, 2018 on caste assuming new identities and associational forms worth 10, 2020 on caste's relevance in a multi-cultural society worth 10, 2022 on the salience of sect worth 15 and 2023 on caste identity being both fluid and static worth 15. D. Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder.

Answer: C. Explanation: Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: 2024 on intercaste versus interreligious marriage worth 10 marks, 2018 on caste assuming new identities and associational forms worth 10, 2020 on caste's relevance in a multi-cultural society worth 10, 2022 on the salience of sect worth 15 and 2023 on caste identity being both fluid and static worth 15. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Verified direct Mains demands?

A. Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder. B. Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared. C. Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory. D. Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: 2024 on intercaste versus interreligious marriage worth 10 marks, 2018 on caste assuming new identities and associational forms worth 10, 2020 on caste's relevance in a multi-cultural society worth 10, 2022 on the salience of sect worth 15 and 2023 on caste identity being both fluid and static worth 15.

Answer: D. Explanation: Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: 2024 on intercaste versus interreligious marriage worth 10 marks, 2018 on caste assuming new identities and associational forms worth 10, 2020 on caste's relevance in a multi-cultural society worth 10, 2022 on the salience of sect worth 15 and 2023 on caste identity being both fluid and static worth 15. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT

Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner. The 2024 demand is routed in the audited 2024-2025 ledger to the Basic owner; the 2018, 2020, 2022 and 2023 demands are routed in the audited 2018-2023 ledger to the Advanced owner, and the Core owner records that Core routing supersedes so that all five are answerable from the Basic spine. Every wording reproduced below was confirmed against the locally held official General Studies Paper-I question papers. No additional caste question, marking scheme or official key is invented, and no objective item is converted into a solved answer.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

5. Indian applications and PYQ mapping

- **FACT: 2024 GS-I PYQ (10 marks, verbatim):** "Intercaste marriages between castes which have socio-economic parity have increased, to some extent, but this is less true of interreligious marriages. Discuss." The expected answer: intercaste marriage between castes of similar socio-economic standing is increasingly tolerated because it does not threaten either family's status or resource base, whereas interreligious marriage crosses a boundary tied to community identity, personal law and often deeper social sanction, making it far less accepted even when economic parity exists - caste boundary-crossing is becoming a status-parity question, while religious boundary-crossing remains an identity-and-belonging question.

- **ANALYSIS:** A locally dominant landholding caste retaining political control of a Panchayat despite a numerically larger but dispersed lower-caste population illustrates the dominant-caste concept in practice.

9. PYQ application

- **FACT: 2024 GS-I (10 marks):** answer structure - define the caste-marriage vs religion-marriage boundary distinction, give the socio-economic-parity condition for intercaste acceptance, explain why religious boundary-crossing carries added identity/personal-law weight, and conclude with the differential-pace observation.

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

Status: 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2024-2025.md.

- **Years represented:** 2024
- **Paper(s):** GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	GS-I	9	Intercaste versus interreligious marriages	Discuss · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Intercaste versus interreligious marriages

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- **FACT: 2024 GS-I (10 marks, verbatim):** "Intercaste marriages between castes which have socio-economic parity have increased, to some extent, but this is less true of interreligious marriages. Discuss." Analytical route: (a) apply the status-parity versus community-boundary distinction; (b) explain why parity may matter for some intercaste matches without universalising it; (c) explain interreligious resistance through community-belonging and kinship boundaries while noting the Special Marriage Act's civil route; (d) conclude that the qualified pattern needs region- and class-sensitive evidence, not a uniform "modernisation" story.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2018, 2020, 2022, 2023
- **Paper(s):** GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 4

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	GS-I	8	Caste assuming new identities and associational forms	Comment · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2020	GS-I	8	Relevance of caste in understanding multi-cultural Indian society	Elaborate with illustrations · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2022	GS-I	18	Salience of sect in Indian society against caste region and religion	Analyse · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2023	GS-I	19	Caste identity in India as both fluid and static	Why · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Caste assuming new identities and associational forms
- Relevance of caste in understanding multi-cultural Indian society
- Salience of sect in Indian society against caste region and religion
- Caste identity in India as both fluid and static

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2024 GS-I Q9

Demand: Intercaste marriages between castes which have socio-economic parity have increased, to some extent, but this is less true of interreligious marriages. Discuss. (Answer in 150 words) 10 marks.

Status: Verified verbatim in the audited 2024-2025 Mains routing ledger and in the locally held official 2024 General Studies Paper-I.

Model solution: Frame the divergence rather than marriage change in general. Claim one: parity loosens the caste boundary, because where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which converts caste boundary-crossing into a status calculation; the qualification is that the premise is explicitly hedged as increasing only to some extent and is not a national prevalence series. Claim two: belonging holds the religious boundary, because interreligious marriage engages community identity, kinship networks and family sanction that economic parity does not remove; the named evidence that personal-law plurality alone is insufficient is the Special Marriage Act, 1954, which supplies a civil route across religions, so the residual resistance must be social rather than merely legal. Add the reproduction point that endogamy remains the least-changed of the four defining features, so neither trend implies that caste is dissolving. Qualify explicitly against the marriage-trend generalisation risk: the premise is hedged as increasing only to some extent and is not a national prevalence series. Conclude that the two boundaries erode at different speeds because they are guarded by different things: status and resources on one side, identity and belonging on the other. Why this earns marks: it answers the comparative demand, supplies the mechanism for each side, names the civil route that defeats the lazy personal-law explanation, and keeps the qualified premise intact.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2018 GS-I Q8

Demand: "Caste system is assuming new identities and associational forms. Hence, caste system cannot be eradicated in India." Comment. (Answer in 150 words) 10 marks.

Status: Routed in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger to the Advanced owner with Core routing recorded as superseding; wording confirmed in the locally held official General Studies Paper-I.

Model solution: Open by accepting the observation and contesting the inference. Claim one: the register has changed, because occupational allocation, service ties and public purity enforcement have weakened under urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment, which proves that the ritual-economic scaffolding is not what now carries caste; the qualification is that stigmatised occupations and their inheritance persist. Claim two: the replacement is organisational, because caste associations and jati panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms, run welfare and educational trusts and organise electoral mobilisation, which proves caste re-entering public life as network and interest rather than as ritual rank; the qualification is that this does not make caste equivalent to ethnicity, since hierarchy and endogamy persist. Claim three: what did not change is endogamy and intimate-sphere discrimination, which is why associational vitality coexists with an unbroken marriage boundary. Comment on the inference: the premise supports the conclusion that caste is not disappearing, but eradication is a normative-institutional question rather than an empirical prediction, and reservation and atrocity-protection doctrine belongs to Polity and Social Justice rather than to a Society answer. Why this earns marks: it separates observation from inference, gives old form, replacement and residue in order, and refuses both the disappearance and the fatalism thesis.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2020 GS-I Q8

Demand: Has caste lost its relevance in understanding the multi-cultural Indian Society? Elaborate your answer with illustrations. (Answer in 150 words) 10 marks.

Status: Routed in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger to the Advanced owner with Core routing recorded as superseding; wording confirmed in the locally held official General Studies Paper-I.

Model solution: Answer that caste has not lost relevance because it is the axis on which India's plurality is stratified rather than merely differentiated, and elaborate across four arenas. Marriage: endogamy remains the most consistently observed defining feature and operates with gotra exogamy, which proves that the most intimate arena is still caste-governed. Ritual and stigma: locally ranked purity and pollution notions still order interaction in many settings, with the qualification that rank order varies regionally and cannot be stated as one national ladder. Economy: occupational decoupling is real under urban and non-farm employment, yet caste-class overlap persists unevenly and cross-cutting differentiation now appears inside single castes, which proves relevance without determinism. Politics: caste associations and dominant castes convert numbers, land and office into local authority, which proves that caste organises interest as well as status. Conclude that caste is analytically indispensable for a multi-cultural society precisely because plurality without stratification would be a different problem, while conceding that its form has shifted from allocation to association. Why this earns marks: it uses four illustrated arenas rather than assertions, concedes the genuine change, and states the exact reason relevance survives.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2022 GS-I Q18

Demand: Analyse the salience of 'sect' in Indian society vis-a-vis caste, region and religion. (Answer in 250 words) 15 marks.

Status: Routed in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger to the Advanced owner with Core routing recorded as superseding; wording confirmed in the locally held official General Studies Paper-I.

Model solution: Begin by refusing a single national ranking and defining the units precisely. A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following constituted by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation; a jati is a birth-ascribed endogamous group; a religion is a faith community; a region is a territorial-cultural group. Analyse arena by arena. Marriage and local status: jati and sub-jati decide the boundary through endogamy, so sect salience is low here even when a jati is concentrated in one sect. Devotional life and shrine politics: sect is decisive, because doctrine, lineage and sacred-site control organise the arena. Electoral mobilisation: jati clusters and religion usually dominate, with sect entering where a sacred site or lineage becomes a political resource. Development grievance: region and language dominate, which is why sect rarely frames disparity claims. Add the overlap caution that a jati concentrated in a sect does not make the two the same kind of unit, since one is a birth-and-marriage axis and the other a voluntary or inherited following. Conclude that sect is a real but arena-bounded axis whose salience rises in ritual and sacred-site contexts and falls in marriage and disparity contexts, so the correct verdict is contextual salience rather than a hierarchy of identities. Why this earns marks: it defines four competing units, ranks them by arena with reasons, resists a false single ranking, and supplies the overlap caution examiners look for.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 5 - 2023 GS-I Q19

Demand: Why is caste identity in India both fluid and static? (Answer in 250 words) 15 marks.

Status: Routed in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger to the Advanced owner with Core routing recorded as superseding; wording confirmed in the locally held official General Studies Paper-I.

Model solution: Open with the level thesis: caste is fluid in rank and static in boundary. Build the static layer first. Endogamy is the most consistently observed defining feature and, with gotra exogamy, reproduces the group every generation; hereditary membership and residential and marital segregation reinforce it; this proves that the mechanism of reproduction has changed least. Build the fluid layer next. Sanskritisation, described by M.N. Srinivas from Rampura fieldwork in Karnataka, lets a jati claim higher local rank by adopting the practices of a locally higher-status caste, with the qualification that it is a claim rather than proof of acceptance; dominance built on numbers, land and office allows a middle-ranked jati to exercise local power above its ritual rank; urban labour markets recruit on credentials and have broken most hereditary occupational allocation; caste associations reinvent the group as an electoral and welfare network. Give the explanation the directive demands: rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed and locally contested, whereas the boundary is not, because it is reproduced through

marriage rather than through opinion. Add the measurement point that no all-India jati count may be quoted and that the Census 2027 caste enumeration announced on 30 April 2025 is prospective. Conclude that fluidity and rigidity are not a contradiction but a division of labour between status and reproduction. Why this earns marks: it explains rather than lists, separates two layers with named evidence, and answers the why directive with a mechanism.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Explain how caste is assuming new identities and associational forms in contemporary India. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Caste is changing register rather than disappearing: ritual allocation and public purity enforcement have weakened while association, network capital and political mobilisation have expanded, and endogamy has changed least.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates.
- Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared.
- Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual.
- An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis.
- Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory.

Qualified conclusion: Caste is changing register rather than disappearing: ritual allocation and public purity enforcement have weakened while association, network capital and political mobilisation have expanded, and endogamy has changed least.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish Sanskritisation from Westernisation with Indian examples. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Sanskritisation is upward emulation inside an existing local hierarchy while Westernisation introduces new values that can subvert that hierarchy, so the two processes can coexist in one community without being the same thing.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows.
- Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy.
- Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs.

Qualified conclusion: Sanskritisation is upward emulation inside an existing local hierarchy while Westernisation introduces new values that can subvert that hierarchy, so the two processes can coexist in one community without being the same thing.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Why is caste identity in India simultaneously negotiable in rank and rigid in boundary? Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, land, office and market position, while the boundary is rigid because marriage reproduces it, which is why rising intercaste marriage and undiminished caste identity can coexist.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations.
- M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows.
- A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank.
- Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared.
- Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory.

Qualified conclusion: Rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, land, office and market position, while the boundary is rigid because marriage reproduces it, which is why rising intercaste marriage and undiminished caste identity can coexist.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Assess the dominant caste as a tool for analysing local power in India. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: The dominant caste explains everyday authority better than ritual rank because it fuses numbers, land and office, but reserved representation and market differentiation now contest it without eliminating it.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank.
- Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs.
- Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment.
- Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual.

Qualified conclusion: The dominant caste explains everyday authority better than ritual rank because it fuses numbers, land and office, but reserved representation and market differentiation now contest it without eliminating it.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Evaluate whether caste today is best understood as hierarchy, as identity or as network. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: No single reading covers all four arenas, because hierarchy still governs marriage and stigma, identity governs mobilisation, and network governs urban opportunity, so the honest verdict is arena-specific rather than a single definition.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit.
- Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework.
- An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis.
- Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance.
- Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual.
- Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder.

Qualified conclusion: No single reading covers all four arenas, because hierarchy still governs marriage and stigma, identity governs mobilisation, and network governs urban opportunity, so the honest verdict is arena-specific rather than a single definition.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Examine why the caste boundary and the religious boundary in marriage erode at different speeds. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Parity is loosening the caste boundary because it protects status and resources, while belonging holds the religious boundary because it protects community identity, and the availability of a civil route shows that legal plurality alone is not the explanation.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings.
- The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead.
- A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit.
- Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations.

Qualified conclusion: Parity is loosening the caste boundary because it protects status and resources, while belonging holds the religious boundary because it protects community identity, and the availability of a civil route shows that legal plurality alone is not the explanation.